

Housing Instability Resources in Chicago

Homeless Prevention

If you are in need of financial assistance to prevent homelessness or to move into new rental housing, please call “311” or (312) 744-5000 and inform the operator you need “short-term help.” The call center provides services in multiple languages. Callers with hearing problems can access TTY equipment at (312) 948-6817.

Emergency Shelter for People Experiencing Homelessness

If you need shelter, call “311” or (312) 744-5000.

Housing for People Experiencing Homelessness

If you are experiencing homelessness, it is highly encouraged to complete a Coordinated Entry housing assessment by visiting an In Person Access Point (see below). Assessments must be updated every 3 months to remain active in the system. Please keep in mind that an assessment does not guarantee housing and may not lead to a housing resource opportunity.

North DFSS North Area Community Service Center 845 W Wilson 312-744-2580 Thursdays 10 AM – 2 PM	North (Youth) Broadway Youth Center 1023 W Irving Park 773-388-1600 Youth 12 -24 (minors receive limited services) Mon, Tues, Thurs & Fri 9 AM – 3 PM Wed 1 PM – 5 PM
Southwest Phoenix Foundation 2456 W 71 st St. 773-457-4429 Mon, Tues, Thurs & Fri 9 AM – 4 PM Wed 9 PM – 1 PM	Southeast Featherfist 2255 E 75 th St 773-721-7088 ext. 219 Mon – Fri 8 AM – 3 PM
South Saint Sabina 1120 W. 79th St., Chicago, IL 60640 773-483-4300 Mon & Wed 9 AM – 1 PM	South DFSS South Chicago Community Service Center 8650 S. Commercial Ave, Chicago, IL 60617 312-747-0331 Thursdays 10 AM – 2 PM
South DFSS Englewood Community Service Center 1140 W 79th St., Chicago, IL 60620 312-747-0200 Tuesdays 10 AM – 2 PM	South DFSS King Center 4314 S. Cottage Grove, Chicago, IL 60653 312-747-2300 Tuesdays 9 AM – 1 PM
Central Chicago Lights 126 East Chestnut Street, Chicago, IL 60611 312-981-3399 Fridays 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM	West Franciscan Outreach 10 S Kedzie Ask for Franciscan Outreach on 1 st Floor 312-746-5642 Mon – Fri 9 AM – 4:30 PM
Phone Access Point 312-971 –4178 Mon, Wed, Thurs & Fri 9 AM – 3 PM Tues 3 PM – 9 PM	

Chicago Housing Authority

For information on how to apply for CHA housing and sign up for site-based wait lists please click here:

<https://applyonline.thecha.org/home>. For questions or further assistance with applying for CHA housing, please call 312-742-8500.

Affordable Housing

The Affordable Housing Resource List provides information on affordable rental housing opportunities that have been supported and developed through the City of Chicago. For building information and instructions on how to reach out to property owners and management teams to inquire about unit availability, please access the list here: [Affordable Housing Resource List](#). Additional affordable housing opportunities throughout the state of Illinois can be found here: ILHousingSearch.org.

211

Please call the 211 or visit 211metrochicago.org for additional supportive services and resources. Callers to 211 can get LIVE assistance with needs such as: food, counseling, income supports, employment, healthcare, and services for specialized populations such as the elderly and persons with disabilities and much more. All calls are free, anonymous, and confidential.

Community City Service Centers

Please visit or contact one of the City's service centers listed below if you or someone you know needs help accessing:

- Food and clothing
- Public benefits eligibility assessments
- Domestic violence assistance
- Job training/placement
- Substance abuse treatment referrals
- Returning citizen programs
- Rental, utility, and other financial assistance programs
- Veteran services and resources

North Ave

845 W. Wilson Ave.
Chicago, IL 60640
312-744-2580

South Chicago

8650 S. Commercial Ave
Chicago, IL 60617
312-7470500

King Center

4314 S. Cottage Grove
Chicago, IL 60653
312-744-2300

Trina Davila Community Service Center

4312 West North Avenue,
Chicago, IL 60639
312-744-2014

Garfield Center

10 S. Kedzie Ave.
Chicago, IL 60612
312-745-5400

Englewood Center

1140 W. 79th Street
Chicago, IL 60620
312-7470200

Facility Service hours Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM. These facilities serve as Warming (32°F) and Cooling (103°F) Centers during periods of extreme weather.

Fair Housing and Tenants' Rights

If you are facing housing instability or eviction, it is important to know your rights under the [Chicago Fair Housing Ordinance](#) and the [Fair Notice Ordinance](#) which extends rights and protects housing seekers and residents from landlord discrimination. If you would like to obtain additional information about ordinances, protected citizen classes, or how to file a fair housing complaint visit the [department website](#), or call 312-744-4111.

For additional tenants' rights issues, concerns, or questions please contact The Metropolitan Tenants Organization (MTO) hotline at 773-292-4988 or get assistance via their online portal: [Get Assistance – Metropolitan Tenants Organization_1 \(tenants-rights.org\)](https://tenants-rights.org). Walk-ins are also welcomed Monday, Wednesday, and Thursday from 10:00AM – 4:00pm.

Legal Aid Services

For legal aid assistance and to apply for free civil legal representation services, please visit [Legal Aid Chicago](#) or call 312-341-1070. Legal Aid Chicago provides free legal aid to low-income individuals for cases pertaining to Family & Safety, Safe and Affordable Housing, Money & Debt, Work & Employment Rights, Health, Disability & Basic Needs, and Immigration.

For additional legal aid assistance please contact the CARPLS Cook County Legal Hotline at 312-738-9200 (Monday-Friday 9AM-4:30PM), or visit their website for more information: [CARPLS Cook County Legal Hotline - CARPLS](#)

Employment Resources

Job seekers can visit a Chicago [American Job Center](#) to receive assistance with employment-related resources including job readiness and training, skills assessment, and resume building. Assistance is available to youth and adults, as well as specialized veteran and disabilities services, all free of charge. Please call in advance to get information about hours, orientation, and workshop details.

Westside American Job Center

605 S. Albany Ave,
Chicago, IL 60612
773-722-3885

Chicago Workforce Center

1700 W. 18th Street,
suite 1917 Chicago,
IL 60608
312-994-8300

American Works of Illinois, Inc.

205 W. Randolph,
Suite 920
Chicago, IL 60606
312-726-5627

Martin Luther King Human Service Center

4314 S. Cottage Grove
Chicago, IL 60653
773-538-5627

Northside American Job Center

1145 N. Wilson, 2nd flr
Chicago, IL 60640
773-334-4747

Community Re-entry Support Centers

Chicago residents who have served time for a felony conviction can access services by calling 311 or by visiting one of the community re-entry support centers.

Howard Area Community Center

7648 N. Paulina Street
Chicago, Illinois 60626
773-262-6622

The Westside Justice Center, Inc.

601 South California Avenue
Chicago, Illinois 60612
773-940-2213

Community Assistance Programs

11715 South Halsted Street
Chicago, Illinois 60628
773-568-1782

Teamwork Englewood

815 W. 63rd Street, 2nd Floor
Chicago, Illinois 60621
773-488-6600

Senior Supportive Services and Centers

A variety of supportive service centers are available citywide to address the diverse needs and interests of older adults. For service and Senior Center information and other resources, please call 312.744.4016 or visit [City of Chicago :: Senior Services.](#)

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Central West Center (60+) 2102
W. Ogden Avenue Chicago, IL
60612
312-746-5300

Northeast (Levy) Senior Center (60+)
2019 W. Lawrence Avenue
Chicago, IL 60625
312-744-0784

Renaissance Court (55+)
78 E. Washington
Chicago, IL 60602
312-744-4550

Southeast (Atlas) Senior Center (60+)
1767 E. 79th Street Chicago, IL
60649
312-747-0189

Veterans

CRRC (Community Resource and Referral Center)
1141 South California Avenue
312-569-8387
Open Monday – Friday 8:00AM – 4:30PM

**Jesse Brown Department of Veteran
Affairs Medical Center**
820 S. Damen
312-569-5750
Open 24 hours

Chicago Department of Public Health Mental Health Centers

The Chicago Department of Public Health Mental Health Centers offer care that provides support for emotional, traumatic, or behavioral difficulties. Support is based on needs identified by the individual, including goals, objectives, and specific mental health services. These services are provided free of charge to all Chicagoans.

Englewood MHC

641 W. 63rd Street Chicago, IL
60616
Monday and Friday
8:30 am – 4:30 pm
312-747-7496

Greater Grand/MID-South MHC

4314 S. Cottage Grove
Chicago, IL 60653
Monday and Friday
8:30 am – 4:30 pm
312-747-7496

Greater Lawn MHC

4150 W. 55th Street
Chicago, IL 60632
Tuesday and Thursday
8:30 am – 7:30 pm
312-747-1020

Lawndale MHC

1105 S. Western Ave.
Chicago, IL 60612
Tuesday and Thursday
8:30 am – 7:30 pm
312-746-5905

North River MHC

5801 N. Pulaski Rd.
Chicago, IL 60646
Wednesday and Thursday
8:30 am – 7:30 pm
312-744-1906

Safety and Crisis Hotlines:

Salvation Army Human Trafficking Hotline: 1-877-606 3158

National Human Trafficking Hotline: 1-888-373-7888

NAMI Mental Health Hotline: 312-563-0445

Illinois Domestic Violence Hotline: 1-877-863-6338

LGBTQ+ Crisis Hotline: 773-871-2273

National Call Center for Homeless Veterans: 1-877-424-3838